

The Cold Read — Facilitator Guide

The complete leader's manual for Module 1: the opening video, then two 45-minute blocks that build one instrument — the Status Board — one question at a time. Newport News figures shown; de-identify in any participant-facing use.

Video + 2 blocks

the complete module

90 min

two 45-min working blocks

2 questions

The Map · The Show-Up

Instrument 1

the Status Board, board-built

HOW THE MODULE RUNS

Promise this module protects: every student seen. Open with the **video** — it puts a face and a dollar figure on why the room is here. Then run **Block 1 (The Map)** and **Block 2 (The Show-Up)**. Across both blocks the board builds and reads its own Status Board; nothing is built for them. You guide; the board builds; the superintendent owns the strategy.

OPEN

► The video — “Money, Made Visible” (~1.5 min)

ITS JOB

Play it before the room does anything. One student, the funding stacked on that child, and the eight questions no stack could answer — ending on the charge to build. It earns the felt need the blocks then answer.

Say (after it ends): “That was the why. For the next ninety minutes, we build the how — with your own record on the table.”

RUN NOTE

Press play and let it run start to finish; it ends on its own. Then move straight into Block 1 — do not debrief the video, let the room carry the feeling into the cold read.

✦ **The video is the hook; the blocks are the work. Keep the seam tight.**

① Block 1 · The Map 45 minutes

protecting question: is every student's path to graduation held?

MIN 0–10

The cold read

WHAT HAPPENS

The board holds its real published stack. One protecting question lands cold. They search the stack and can't assemble the answer — it holds a number and a year, not a pattern by school and subgroup.

Say: *"Put your hand on the stack. In five minutes, tell me — by school and subgroup — how many of your students are off track to graduate, who owns it, and whether the trend is up or down."*

WHAT THEY FIND

Graduation reads **97.26%** — one number, one year. By school? By subgroup? The trend line? The owner? The stack doesn't hold it.

✦ **Land the line: a document shows a year; an instrument shows the pattern. The villain is the missing tool, never the board.**

MIN 10–20

The stack becomes two questions

WHAT HAPPENS

Focus the whole pile to the two questions this movement protects; everything else waits for later movements.

Say: *"Answer these two, and no student in this division goes unseen. Everything on this table serves them."*

THE TWO PROTECTING QUESTIONS

- ① **The Map** — is every student's path to graduation held, by school and subgroup?
- ② **The Show-Up** — who's slipping from attendance, early enough to reach them?

MIN 20–40

Build the Status Board

WHAT HAPPENS

The board drafts its own Status Board for The Map and locks two fields: **Scope** (which students, schools, subgroups are in the view) and **Metric** (count · owner · trend). This starts the evidence record that runs all year.

Say: *"You build it, in your words, from your stack. You keep it. We certify it once it runs."*

BUILD FROM THE SAME STACK

The Map Elevate 2030 — grad goal

VDOE Profile — 97.26%, cohort + subgroup

✦ **Nothing new to buy. The documents on the table become the instrument.**

MIN 40–45

Rehearse the quarterly read

WHAT HAPPENS

Pick one data point and run the read out loud — the cadence they will repeat every quarter until it's a habit.

Say: *"Give me this quarter's count, name the owner, read the trend against last quarter."*

THE TELL

✦ **The tell is never a score — it's whether the board can answer the question with its own evidence, on cadence.**

② Block 2 · The Show-Up 45 minutes

protecting question: who's slipping — early enough to reach them?

MIN 0–10

The cold read, shifted to the signal

WHAT HAPPENS

Same stack, new question. The board looks for who is chronically absent right now — and finds a division number, not a living signal by school and subgroup.

Say: *"Same stack, five minutes. Who is chronically absent — by school, by subgroup — and is it getting better or worse this quarter?"*

WHAT THEY FIND

Chronic absence reads **23%** baseline, down **15.9%** last year — real wins. But by school? By subgroup? This quarter's direction? The stack holds a number, not a signal.

✦ **A win you can't steer is a win you can lose.**

MIN 10–20

Why attendance is the signal

WHAT HAPPENS

Frame attendance as the earliest chance to reach a student. The Map shows where a student lands; The Show-Up catches them while there is still time to bring them back — with the resources already in place.

Say: “This is the number that tells you a student is drifting while you can still reach them. That is the point of watching it.”

THE RECOVERY FRAME

Seen early, a student is **still reachable** — connected to the supports that exist. Left unseen, the same student is **harder to bring back**. The board’s job is to see it in time.

✦ **This is about recovering students early, never about cost.**

MIN 20–40

Add The Show-Up to the board you started

WHAT HAPPENS

Not a new instrument — the second row. The board adds The Show-Up to the Status Board from Block 1 and locks Scope and Metric for attendance. Now one board holds both protecting questions.

Say: “Same board, second row. Chronic-absence rate, owner, trend — by school and subgroup.”

BUILD FROM THE SAME STACK

The Show-Up

VDOE Profile — chronic absence ↓15.9%, by school

Elevate 2030 — -2 pts/yr goal

✦ **The proof is already in the record: 16 schools cut chronic absence by more than 20% in one year.**

MIN 40–45

Lock the cadence that makes it last

WHAT HAPPENS

Set the quarterly cadence: same data point, same read, every quarter. A win read once a year is a win the board forgets.

Say: “Every quarter, this data point, read the same way — count, owner, trend against last quarter. Lock it now.”

THE RHYTHM

Chronic absence, by school — read **Q1 → Q2 → Q3 → Q4**, always the same way. The cadence is what carries the win past the plan cycle.

THE ASSIGNMENT THE MODULE ENDS ON

YOUR ASSIGNMENT — QUARTER 1

Instrument 1: the Status Board

Finalize the signal set as a board. Stand up the Status Board on your own data with both questions live — Scope and Metric locked. Give **one** quarterly read before Q2: count · owner · trend. That is Instrument 1 of four.

THE STATUS BOARD — BUILD TEMPLATE

Fill this with the board, in the room, across both blocks. The cells are theirs to define; you hold the pen for no one.

QUESTION	SCOPE (THEY DEFINE)	METRIC — COUNT · OWNER · TREND	BUILT FROM
① The Map graduation path	<i>which schools · which subgroups · cohort</i>	<i>off-track count · owner · trend vs last read</i>	Elevate 2030 VDOE Profile
② The Show-Up chronic absence	<i>by school · by subgroup · threshold</i>	<i>chronic-absence rate · owner · trend vs last quarter</i>	VDOE Profile Elevate 2030

THE YEAR THIS MODULE STARTS

This module stands up Instrument 1. The quarters build the other three. The board's first online carry: **finalize the signal set — as a board.**

Q1 · Status Board

built here — both questions

Q2 · Reach Map

next quarter

Q3 · Handoff Log

next quarter

Q4 · Cadence Panel

all four live

FACILITATOR NOTES

- **Grace-first, always.** The villain is the missing instrument, never the board. Name the systems gap, never a person's deficit.
- **Recovery-first language.** The Show-Up is about reaching students early and getting them back on track with the resources already there — never about cost or what is “cheap” to fix.

- **The board sees; the superintendent steers.** The board builds the visibility tool and reads it. The superintendent owns and steers the strategy toward the schools the data flags — not dollar for dollar, but by name.
- **The board builds it.** EJC teaches and guides; the board builds its own instrument and keeps the skills. Never “we build it for you.”
- **Aggregate only.** Count, owner, trend — by school and subgroup. Never a student’s name; suppress groups under 10.
- **The tell is the answerability count,** never a score or a grade on the board.

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Sources (public): graduation 97.26%, chronic-absence baseline 23% and change ↓15.9%, and 16 schools improving >20% — VDOE / NNPS public reporting (Dec 2025). Elevate 2030 measures — division strategic plan. Internal facilitator guide; de-identify for participant use.